The Duck and the Kangaroo (Edward Lear)

Verse 1

D
Said the Duck to the Kangaroo,
G *D*
‘Good gracious! how you hop!
G *D*
Over the fields and the water too,
E7 *A*
As if you never would stop!
A7 *D*
My life is a bore in this nasty pond,
F#7 *Bm*
And I long to go out in the world beyond!
D
I wish I could hop like you!’
A7 *D*
Said the Duck to the Kangaroo.

Verse 2

D
Please give me a ride on your back!
G *D*
Said the Duck to the Kangaroo.
G
I would sit quite still, and say nothing but “Quack,”
E7 *A*
The whole of the long day through!
A7 *D*
And we’d go to the Dee, and the Jelly Bo Lee,
F#7 *Bm*
Over land, and over the sea;—
D
Please take me a ride! O do!’
A7 *D*
Said the Duck to the Kangaroo.

Verse 3

D
Said the Kangaroo to the Duck,
G *D*
‘This requires some little reflection;
G *D*
Perhaps on the whole it might bring me luck,
E7 *A*
And there seems but one objection,
A7 *D*
Which is, if you’ll let me speak so bold,
F#7 *Bm*
Your feet are unpleasantly wet and cold,
D
And would probably give me the flu (roo-Matiz)!
A7 *D*
said the Kangaroo.

Verse 4

D
Said the Duck, ‘As I sate on the rocks,
G D
I have thought over that completely,
G D
And I bought four pairs of worsted socks
E7 A
Which fit my web-feet neatly.
A7 D
And to keep out the cold I’ve bought a cloak,
F#7 Bm
And every day a cigar I’ll smoke,
D
All to follow my own dear true
A7 D
Love of a Kangaroo!’

Verse 5

D
Said the Kangaroo to the Duck,
G D
My dear old friend duck why,
G D
If you wanted to see the world,
E7 A
Couldn’t you just fly?
A7 D
The Duck replied, ‘How silly,
F#7 Bm
I’ve two fine wings, it’s true,
D
But I could not fly through the evening sky,
A D
weighted down by a Kangaroo!’

Verse 6

D
Said the Kangaroo, ‘I’m ready!
G
All in the moonlight pale;
G D
But to balance me well, dear Duck, sit steady!
E7 A
And quite at the end of my tail!’
A7 D
So away they went with a hop and a bound,
F#7 Bm
And they hopped the whole world three times round;
D
And who so happy,—O who,
A7 D
As the Duck and the Kangaroo?

D A7 D
And who so happy,—O who, as the Duck and the Kangaroo?